CJ Nowacek

Pipeline Developer: Infrastructure & Automation

Cleveland Heights, Ohio
(216) 469 0959
cj@cjnowacek.com
cjnowacek.com
cjnowacek

Professional Summary

Pipeline and infrastructure developer for an architectural visualization studio: Python automation, render-farm deployment, and Windows administration. Focused on reliable, unattended automation: silent software deployment, scheduled-task orchestration, and git-based release workflows, alongside Microsoft 365/Azure administration. Also adjunct faculty at the Cleveland Institute of Art. Background in technical art; shipped SMITE 2 at Hi-Rez Studios.

Core Skills

Infrastructure	Windows & Linux administration; Microsoft 365 & Azure; user/device management; remote access
Automation	Python, Bash, PowerShell; silent software deployment; scheduled-task orchestration; batch processing
Render Farm	Deployment and submission automation for 3ds Max render farms
Tools	Git, Perforce, Jira, Confluence, PyQt, pytest, PyInstaller

Professional Experience

2026–Present **CGI Pipeline Developer**, *MediaLab 3D Solutions*, Remote

- Automated remote deployment of 3ds Max and production plugins across the studio's Windows render farm: silent, unattended installs with privilege-elevation handling
- Leading the farm's migration to a modern render-management platform: built the silent install and update tooling for the new client and am porting deployment and submission workflows
- Designed a Python scene-automation framework for scene preparation, diagnostics, and farm submission, accessible via CLI, PyQt desktop app, and native 3ds Max integration; ships as a packaged desktop app with an in-app update offer
- Added a fast diagnostics tier that reads scene metadata from .max files without launching 3ds Max, with cached health reports
- Brought the studio's legacy MaxScript toolset under version control with a repeatable build-and-release workflow, and maintain the git-based packaging that distributes tools to production
- Built an AI-assisted development workflow with regression tests and independent review before release
- Author documentation and train production staff on each tool

2026–Present **Adjunct Faculty, Animation**, *Cleveland Institute of Art*, Cleveland, OH

- Co-teach ANIM 312, 3D Rigging & Problem Solving, and advise BFA seniors on senior projects, portfolios, and demo reels

2026 **MaxScript Specialist (Contract)**, *MediaLab 3D Solutions*, Remote

- Built MaxScript and Python automation for asset processing and repetitive scene operations in 3ds Max; converted to full-time pipeline developer role

2025–2026 **System Administrator (Contract)**, *Yaggy Trucking*, Remote

- Administered Microsoft 365 and Azure environments; managed remote access and user accounts
- Automated installation processes and resolved IT issues across users and systems

2025 **Technical Artist (Contract)**, *Anuttacon via GoDemic*, Remote

- Developed automated asset-processing tools in Python and MEL, iterating on feedback to improve usability and reliability
- Wrote user documentation and incorporated stakeholder feedback to meet production needs

2024–2025 **Technical Animator (Contract)**, *Hi-Rez Studios*, Remote

- Built Python and MaxScript automation for asset integration and deployment in Unreal Engine 5
- Collaborated with Animation, Design, and QA to find bottlenecks and automate milestone-delivery steps

2023–2024 **Associate Technical Animator**, *Hi-Rez Studios*, Alpharetta, GA

- Shipped **SMITE 2** as part of the technical animation team: character rigging alongside the Python/MaxScript tooling that supported the asset pipeline
- Developed automated batch-processing tools in Python and MaxScript, cutting manual asset-processing time by **25%** and improving pipeline reliability
- Built automated asset-migration pipelines across engine versions, reducing integration errors
- Wrote documentation and runbooks for automated processes to support team scaling and knowledge transfer

Education

2023 **BFA, Animation and Game Design**, *Cleveland Institute of Art*, Cleveland, OH
Senior Project: Cinematic story driven game

Updated October 18, 2026